

Work Experience Requirement for UK Medical Schools

2026-2027

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University	Work Experience Requirements
Aberdeen	Relevant hospital or GP experience is useful. If obtaining work experience is difficult, explain this in your Personal Statement and describe alternative ways you've researched a medical career.
Anglia Ruskin(ARU)	Healthcare sector experience is desirable, both clinical and non-clinical (nursing homes, charities, pharmacies, GP surgeries, hospitals). Other work experience demonstrating transferable skills like communication and problem-solving is also considered.
Aston	No healthcare work experience required in Personal Statement or interviews. However, applicants must have a realistic view of Medicine. Valuable experience can be gained in non-medical environments.
Barts(QMUL)	No specific type or amount required. Work experience can be voluntary or paid. Shadowing doctors isn't necessary volunteering in care homes or charities is equally valuable.
Birmingham	Seek experiences involving care or support for vulnerable individuals, either providing care yourself or observing others. If unavailable, virtual experiences like Observe GP are acceptable alternatives.
Brighton and Sussex	No specific requirements. Applicants must demonstrate realistic understanding of Medicine, what it means to be a doctor, and experience engaging with diverse people. BSMS offers virtual work experience.
Bristol	Minimum two weeks recommended. If clinical experience is difficult to obtain, seek customer service roles, care/health environment volunteering, or youth group work.
Buckingham	No requirements specified.
Cambridge	Strongly advised (not required) to undertake paid or voluntary work experience in health or social care organizations to understand medical careers and assess your suitability.

Cardiff	Demonstrate insight into medical careers through experience and reflection in caring environments. Recognize that opportunities vary by socioeconomic, cultural, and geographical circumstances.
Dundee	Work experience is discussed at interview. They recognize pandemic-related limitations in obtaining experience.
Edge Hill University	No requirements specified.
Edinburgh	Gain understanding through work experience, shadowing health professionals, health promotion, talking to doctors/students, attending open days/conferences, and engaging with medical content. Quality over quantity valued.
Exeter	Not part of standard entry requirements. All applicants welcome regardless of work experience.
Glasgow	Medical setting experience unnecessary, but candidates should speak with a doctor about medical careers or research through books/newspapers. Expect awareness of current medical profession issues and interest in caring, demonstrated through community work.
Hull York	Demonstrate people-focused care through relevant work experience. Seek diverse experiences (voluntary or paid) in healthcare and other people-facing settings. Clinical experience not essential.
Imperial	Pandemic has limited healthcare work experience opportunities. Consider online platforms for clinical insights or gain experience in public-facing roles with teamwork. Seek future medics who participate in school/college life, reflect on broader societal experiences, and understand responsible caring roles.
Keele	Complete roles & responsibilities form showing direct engagement in supportive/caring roles, handling responsibility, and understanding how others benefit from your help. Medical or formal caring settings not required. Workplace shadowing not credited.
Kent and Medway	No requirements specified.
King's	Normally expect work experience in caring environments or medical observation. If unavailable, demonstrate

	experience in public-facing settings (pharmacy, restaurant, etc.).
Lancaster	Relevant experience needed to confirm Medicine is right for you. Need not be doctor shadowing—any healthcare setting experience providing medical career insights works. Non-healthcare experience acceptable if you relate developed skills to Medicine.
Leeds	Aware of pandemic impact on work experience opportunities and will consider this. Clinical work experience generally not required.
Leicester	Medical work experience not essential. Must demonstrate public communication experience through some work form.
Lincoln	Usually required to provide work experience evidence, including volunteering or paid employment.
Liverpool	Read Medical Schools Council statements on core values/attributes for Medicine and guidance on gaining relevant work experience.
Manchester	Complete Non-Academic Information Form about hands-on caring roles (medical or non-medical). Demonstrate clear understanding of studying Medicine and doctor's role. Doctor shadowing not essential and doesn't substitute hands-on caring experience.
Newcastle	No specific requirements. Interview assesses commitment to caring. Finding primary/secondary care experience can be difficult, but caring commitment can be shown through volunteering and other means.
Norwich/UEA	Gain insight into being a doctor through healthcare organization work experience, care-related volunteering, or healthcare assistant employment. Complete and bring work experience form to interview.
Nottingham	Expect work experience including care-related volunteering, volunteering with disadvantaged groups, or paid employment involving general public interaction.
Oxford	No specific hospital work experience requirement (difficult to arrange). Any voluntary work is beneficial.

	Show realistic understanding of medical careers and potential to become effective, caring doctors.
Plymouth	No requirements specified. Personal Statements and work experience not considered in interview selection.
Queen's Belfast	Personal Statement should evidence career research efforts: clinical observational experience, medical careers conferences, or care setting voluntary work.
Sheffield	Normally expect work experience showing realistic medical profession insight and understanding of doctor's complex role. If medical environment experience unavailable, consider care homes, hospices, youth centers, childcare, or community volunteering. Hands-on roles extremely valuable.
Southampton	Any work experience valuable for Medicine (working with diverse backgrounds). Retail, restaurant, bar work demonstrate customer service, problem-handling, and initiative. Medical profession experience provides greater career pathway insight.
St Andrews	Work or shadowing experience required in caring or health environments: hospitals, GP surgeries, nursing homes, hospices, or work with people with ill health/disabilities.
St George's	Relaxed work experience requirements due to pandemic. Still require understanding of healthcare professional realities and necessary skills/attributes for medical careers. Online resources offer valuable healthcare sector insights.
Sunderland	No specific amount/type requirements. Expect realistic understanding of Medicine and being a doctor, experience with diverse people, and understanding of caring profession realities.
UCL	Main factor: demonstrate and reflect on what you learned (about yourself and Medicine). No specific clinical experience requirement or time duration. Understand pandemic difficulties; recommend reading Medical Schools Council work experience guide.

UCLan	Practical caring role experience extremely valuable for understanding medical careers. Paid employment interactions also relevant. Value active involvement helping underprivileged, unwell, disabled, or distressed people. Valuable experiences include handling demanding situations and exceeding duties to help others.
Warwick	Must complete minimum 70 hours of health/social care work experience in last three years. Require variety: at least two different organizations and at least two different roles/professions.